A Princess's Nightmare

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/50263846.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Plain Doll (Bloodborne)

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by Ivygor (DrFanfictionPodcast)

Summary

Adora's gone to Yharnam to try and heal whatever traces of Horde Prime remain in her blood. And when she doesn't come back, Catra goes after her.

Notes

This fic was written by Ivy Fox, aka Ivygor for episode 10, “Crossovers”, of the fanfiction podcast Dr. Fanfiction’s Monster.

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra opened her eyes, her vertical-slit pupils adjusting rapidly to the light. The light was the pale, pure white of moonlight, diffused by a gentle mist. But it was brighter than the light of any moon she had ever seen, alighting where she stood almost as if it was day. Where did she stand? The first thing she knew about it, ears gently swivelling, was that it was perfectly silent. There was no wind, no movement of life. Stepping carefully, claws primed, she turned, observing a small island jutting out from a sea of fog. Cobblestone paths lined with wrought iron fence and gravestones, a heavy wooden building with its doors closed, an ornamental doll with ceramic skin slumped on an outcropping beneath it.

"Creepy," she said with a shuddering sneer, "how did I…?"

She closed her eyes again, trying to remember how she got here. All of her recent memories were hazy, as if she had been dreaming and had just woken up. She remembered lying on a table, fur prickling as someone injected something into her, trying hard to keep her composure and not run or fight. This was part of a contract she had signed, a deal she had to make to get where she needed to go. She remembered baring her fangs at something large and fearsome, violence, pain, and then… waking up here. Something like that.

But there was one word that echoed in her mind stronger than almost any thought; Hunter. It was a good word for her, she thought. Something that she would be good at. But there was a sickening familiarity to it, too, because she wasn't just a Hunter, she was SOMETHING'S Hunter. Whoever she had signed that contract with- not the old man in the chair, whoever she had really signed it with- she was their Hunter, she hunted for them. None of this was immediately obvious, but she knew it because she knew this feeling, of being in thrall to some eldritch force so much larger than herself, of being a pawn in someone else's game.

Well screw. That. She wasn't interested in playing. Catra opened her eyes and looked up again at the moon. The tiniest bit of insight into what this place was suddenly came to her, even if it

was just a small drop in a bucket. And then there was a rustling behind her, and when she turned the doll was alive.

“Hello, good Hunter-”

“-just, call me Catra, okay?” The way this thing said the word Hunter, with so much love and adoration, made Catra tense.

The doll tilted its head, and then continued, “-good hunter,” Catra sighed, “I am a doll, here in this dream to look after you. Honourable hunter, pursue the echoes of blood and I will-”

“Hey, so, I don’t actually care about whatever you’re talking about,” Catra interrupted bluntly, “I’m looking for someone.”

“A Hunter?”

Catra snorted. “Probably, she loves playing the hero…” she rooted around in her pockets until she found the photo of Adora she had brought with her, showing it to the doll. “Her. Adora. Sometimes she gets two feet taller and has a big glowy sword. You seen her?”

Adora. Whatever had happened in the core, whatever Horde Prime had done to her, had left something in her that even magic couldn’t heal. Something that tainted her blood. In search of a way to fix it, they had heard of this place, of Yharnam, the only city in the galaxy that, supposedly, could cure any bloodborne disease. And so of course, like she always did, Adora had gone there alone. And then of course, like always happened, Catra had gone after her when she didn’t come back.

The doll tilted its head again. “Yes, I have seen this hunter. She left the dream some time ago, and I have not seen her since.”

“Where did she go?”

The doll pointed at a large headstone with a peaked top, a swarm of pale little… things cavorting at its base. Catra intuitively understood this to be an exit, somehow, and walked intently up to

it. But as she reached to touch it, she hesitated. She remembered the beast that had… killed her? And sent her here, remembered its enormous claws and teeth. And then she looked at her own claws and, for the first time ever, felt like they might just not cut it.

Thankfully, the wooden building, who's doors had opened when the doll came alive, was happy to provide. It was full of fantastical, if archaic, weaponry, from enormous axes that turned into even bigger axes, to canes that turned into bladed whips, to half a dozen types of shining guns. But none of it quite felt… her. But, as she looted around the workshop, taking care not to wake the old man in the corner- she didn't need a monologue from anyone else- she eventually found a wooden box with a rusted lock on it that she easily slashed open. And what was inside was perfect. A huge, two-pronged claw fashioned from the bones of something horrifying that slipped on over her forearm. It thrummed with a terrible power that begged to be tapped into, and fit like a glove. Grabbing a pistol for good measure, Catra headed out into the night.

—

After hours that felt like days that felt like weeks of pushing her way through the streets of Yharnam, cutting her way through beast and man and whatever else stood in her way, Catra found herself at the foot of Yharnam's Grand Cathedral, a massive structure that she refused to be impressed by. Making her way inside, up a set of steps flanked by twisted statues that looked past her with their many eyed gaze, she found her at last- Adora, kneeling in front of a massive, white-furred beast she had seemingly felled.

"Adora!" Catra cried out, breaking into a run, "finally, I found-"

But something was wrong. Adora was shuddering unnaturally, her breath heavy and ragged. Scattered around her were a dozen empty vials of mistrative blood, and she was muttering under her breath.

"...Adora?" Catra hesitated, her tail going stiff with worry.

And then Adora began to change. There was an awful sound of bones cracking as her body grew, white clothes ripping to reveal patches of long, blonde fur. There was a spray of blood, tinged with bright green, as claws ripped from her elongated fingers. By the time Adora finally turned to look at Catra she was nearly unrecognisable beneath the beast she had become.

Catra scowled. "You really always gotta make it complicated, don't you, Adora?" Adora gave a screeching cry in response, and Catra gripped her weapons tight.

Adora charged, swiping at Catra with one of her claws. Catra deftly sidestepped, striking back with a slash from her own. Beasthood had certainly made Adora more of a threat, but only if she managed to land a hit. And it also made her clumsier, less tactical, and easier to read. Catra danced around her, acrobatically dodging each attack while finding ample opportunity to counterattack, the hardened bone of her weapon gashing at Adora's flesh, matting her golden fur with red. Catra didn't exactly like hurting her girlfriend, this was hardly a friendly spar. But Adora could take it, she knew, and if this is what it took to bring her back to her senses, so be it.

A poorly spaced leap left Adora prone in front of Catra, who lifted her gun and shot a round of quicksilver right at her face. Adora reeled back and Catra moved in, sinking her claw into Adora's flesh. Pulling herself off of the weapon with a howl of pain, Adora scrambled back to the far end of the church, giving Catra a chance to catch her breath. And then she changed again. Lifting her hand in the air, Adora let out a terrible roar, and there was a blinding flash of light. When Catra's vision recovered, Adora's fur now shimmered with a rainbow light, she was adorned with golden armour, and she clutched an eight-foot long magical sword in her clawed grasp.

"Oh, come on!" Yelled Catra indignantly, "do we really have to do the Princess thing now!?"

Beast-Ra charged again, swinging with her blade. And this time, Catra barely dodged, almost caught out by the sudden increase in her opponent's speed and power. The tables turned, and now Catra was just surviving, trying to stay alive beneath the flurry of blows from the magically-augmented cleric beast. But Catra had a trick up her own sleeve. Reaching out to the Beast Claw with her mind, she tapped into the dark power she had felt in it earlier. She tossed away her gun as the claws of her off-hand became monstrously sharp and large, and her fur grew long and shaggy. She roared at Beast-Ra furiously, now half beast herself.

The two of them clashed violently, teeth against teeth, claw against claw, sword against bone. But Catra was still herself, not giving into the beast entirely, and this once again gave her the upper hand. With a single furious backand, she knocked the sword out of Beast-Ra's hand and threw her to the ground belly-up. Leaping atop her, Catra pinned her throat between the two prongs of the Beast Claw, giving off a threatening growl. And then she leaned forward and kissed Adora on her fuzzy snout.

A warm, gentle light enveloped both of them, and when it dissipated, the two were lying on the stone floor, no longer beasts. Catra ripped the Beast Claw off her hand and threw it to the side, turning her head to face a very confused Adora.

"Catra…?" Her voice was groggy, as if she had just woken up from a deep sleep. "What… what happened?"

"Hey Adora," Catra answered, with as much of a smile as she could muster, exhaustion settling into her, "how many times am I gonna have to save you like that, huh?"

End Notes

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